

ACCESSIBILITY ASSESSMENT REPORT

Clearwater Public Library

Every barrier found. Every fix *sequenced*.

56%

Rating score, 709 of 1,259

28

Measured findings

47

Points to Certified

3

Phases, \$71K–\$123K

PREPARED FOR

Town of Clearwater

FACILITY

Clearwater Public Library

1204 Main Street, Clearwater AB T0M 0M0

ASSESSED

April 14, 2026

ASSESSOR

Carl Christie

RHFAC Professional

- Every finding measured on site, cited to CSA/ASC B651:23 and an RHFAC item, and pinned to a plan
- A phased capital plan that maps onto budget cycles
- Every fix ranked by compliance points recovered per dollar
- Grant programs matched to the work that qualifies

RHFAC v4.0 RATING SURVEY

CSA/ASC B651:23

LASER-MEASURED ±1/16 IN

SEVERITY-MAPPED PLANS

The short *version*.

Clearwater Public Library · assessed April 14, 2026. Share this page on its own; the detail follows.

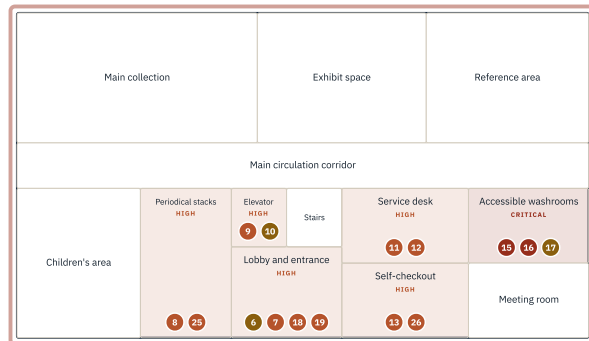
56%	28	47	\$11,460–\$19,860
Rating score	Findings	Points to Certified	Life-safety work, first

How the 47-point gap closes

Mandatory life-safety work (Phase 0) recovers 15 points for \$11,460–\$19,860. These six actions recover 35 more, reaching 759, past the 756 needed, for **\$3,760–\$6,370**.

1	Move periodical shelving (1,200 mm aisle)	+8 pts · \$0
2	Directional sign to accessible washroom	+5 pts · \$180–\$320
3	Adjust entrance door closer to 38 N	+5 pts · \$180–\$350
4	Reprogram elevator audio announcements	+4 pts · \$200–\$400
5	Repaint parking crossing markings	+3 pts · \$400–\$800
6	Lowered service counter section	+10 pts · \$2,800–\$4,500

Where the problems are – main floor



Dark red: critical · orange: high · amber: medium. Each area is also labelled in words. Numbers are finding numbers; full plans in Section 05.

It does not have to happen at once

Phase 0 – immediate: \$11,460–\$19,860. Visual fire alarms, an area of rescue and grab bars.

Phase 1 – Year 1: \$37,160–\$63,570. Passes the points threshold and rebuilds the entrance ramp, which certification also requires (792 points).

Phase 2 – Year 2: \$22,500–\$40,000. Lighting and the universal washroom.

Full plan: **\$71,120–\$123,430** before grants. Two funding programs are matched to this work in Section 09.

Questions before council sees this?

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Where to start

Council

The one-page summary, the executive summary (Section 02) and the severity map (Section 05).

Administration and finance

The ranking (Section 06), the capital plan (Section 07) and the funding programs (Section 09).

Facilities and contractors

The findings (Section 04) with the zone index (Section 05), which shows which rooms to visit and what each area costs.

Numbers are used the same way throughout. A finding number in Section 04 is the pin number on the plans in Section 05, and every estimate is counted once, so the zone index, the ranking and the capital plan all total \$71,120–\$123,430.

01 · WHAT THIS REPORT IS

A decision-support document, *not a compliance certificate*.

This is a Novo Accessibility Assessment produced using RHFAC v4.0 methodology and CSA/ASC B651:23. It is a pre-complaint documentation baseline for municipal capital planning.

What it is

A measured, scored record of every accessibility barrier at this facility, each one located on a floor plan, costed, ranked by the compliance points it recovers per dollar, and sequenced into phases that map onto budget cycles.

What it is not

It is not an RHFAC Registry submission and does not confer RHF certification. Formal certification requires submission to the RHFAC Registry by a designated RHFAC Professional for adjudication by the Rick Hansen Foundation.

Reaching 60% is not the same as being certified

The Guide to RHF Accessibility Certification sets prerequisites that must be met as well as the score. Certified needs an accessible public entrance and access to all key functional spaces; Gold adds thirteen more, including visual fire alarms and a universal washroom. A site can reach the threshold and still not certify. Separately, Novo corrects life-safety findings first (Phase 0) whatever the certification goal.

How to read a finding

Every finding shows what was measured, what the standard requires, the survey item that scores it, the cost, its place on the plan and its phase. The RHFAC item sets points; the B651 clause sets whether the measurement passes.

REFERENCE	DOCUMENT	EDITION	WHAT IT GOVERNS
RHFAC	RHFAC Rating Survey — Rick Hansen Foundation	v4.0, September 2024	Scoring. Category and item point values, applicability, and the 60% and 80% certification thresholds.
B651	CSA/ASC B651, Accessible design for the built environment	2023 edition	Technical requirements. The measurable minimum behind each finding — dimensions, forces, slopes and heights.
Prerequisites	Guide to RHF Accessibility Certification — Rick Hansen Foundation	v4.2, June 2024	The certification and Gold prerequisites that must be met in addition to the score.
Legal context	Alberta Building Code; Alberta Human Rights Act (duty to accommodate)	Current	The regulatory and human-rights framework this documentation baseline is prepared against.
Cost basis	Novo cost index — Alberta contractor pricing (see Section 10)	2026	Order-of-magnitude cost ranges for capital planning. Not a quotation.

No B651 minimum: scored by RHFAC, but no B651:23 clause sets a measurable requirement, so the finding is advisory. A section reference such as RHFAC 2.2 § has no numbered item, so no points are attributed. Two findings under one survey item share its points, counted once.

02 · EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Certification is 47 points away, and the route there is *mostly low cost*.

For administration and council — Town of Clearwater

The Clearwater Public Library scored **709 of 1,259 applicable points (56%)** across a full RHFAC v4.0 assessment conducted April 14, 2026. That is moderate compliance, 47 points below the 756-point threshold for RHF Accessibility Certified status.

Three life-safety problems, recorded as five findings

There are no visual fire alarms on either floor (findings 23–24), so a person with a hearing impairment receives no warning during a fire. There is no designated area of rescue on the upper floor (22), leaving anyone who cannot use stairs with no safe place to wait during an evacuation. The accessible washroom grab bars are mounted 35–40 mm below the required minimum (15–16) and do not give reliable support. These are corrected first, regardless of certification goals and regardless of cost: **\$11,460–\$19,860**, recovering 15 points. Visual fire alarms are also an RHF Gold prerequisite.

After that work, **32 points remain**. Six low-cost actions recover 35, enough to close the gap: moving the periodical shelving, a directional sign to the accessible washroom, a door closer adjustment, an elevator audio reprogram, repainting the parking crossing and a lowered service counter section. Together they cost **\$3,760–\$6,370**. Repositioning the shelving costs nothing; the lowered counter section is the largest single gain at 10 points. Points are not the only test: RHF also requires an accessible public entrance, so the ramp rebuild and the door closer adjustment are both scheduled in Year 1.

The full plan covers 25 of the 28 findings, costs an estimated **\$71,120–\$123,430** before grants and lifts the score to 799 (63%). Gold status (1,008 points) needs further work beyond these findings; Section 07 explains why. The federal Enabling Accessibility Fund funds up to \$125,000 per project under its small projects component, but no intake is open at the time of writing; this report supplies the needs documentation an application requires.

PHASE 0

Immediate

\$11,460–\$19,860

+15 pts → 724 / 1,259 (58%)

PHASE 1

Year 1 (2026–27)

\$37,160–\$63,570

+68 pts → 792 / 1,259 (63%)

PHASE 2

Year 2 (2027–28)

\$22,500–\$40,000

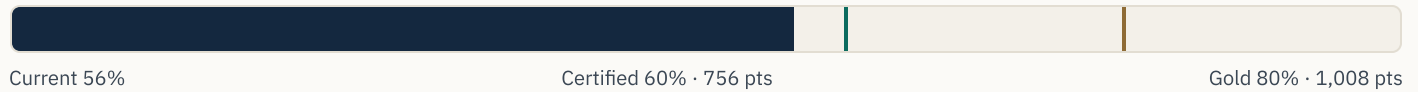
+7 pts → 799 / 1,259 (63%)

The severity map in Section 05 shows where each finding sits in the building. The washrooms and the upper-floor stairwell are the two critical areas.

03 · SCORE SUMMARY

709 of 1,259 applicable points.

Categories 9 (Residential Units) and 10 (Trails and Pathways) do not apply to this building type and are excluded from both the score and the maximum, as RHFAC scores them.



#	CATEGORY	EARNED	MAX	%	PROFILE
1	Vehicular Access	54	75	72%	
2	Exterior Approach and Entrance	89	197	45%	
3	Interior Circulation	212	312	68%	
4	Interior Services and Environment	78	167	47%	
5	Sanitary Facilities	117	212	55%	
6	Wayfinding and Signage	38	84	45%	
7	Emergency Systems	36	70	51%	
8	Additional Use of Spaces	38	70	54%	
11	Mind-Friendly Environments	19	30	63%	
12	Technology & Innovation	28	42	67%	
Total — 10 applicable categories		709	1,259	56%	

Why the findings do not explain every missing point

The building is 550 points short of the maximum, but the 28 findings account for 102 of them. RHFAC awards many points for features that go beyond minimum requirements, so points can be missing where nothing fails a standard. The findings are the places where the building falls short of a requirement or a prerequisite.

Prerequisites outstanding

Certified: an accessible public entrance — the ramp (3–5) and door force (7) must be corrected first. **Gold, also:** visual fire alarms (23–24), a universal washroom (17), tactile warnings (5, 19) and tactile room signs (20–21). All are in the capital plan.

04 · FINDINGS BY CATEGORY

28 findings across 10 categories.

Every category in scope was inspected. Each finding carries what was measured, what the standard requires, which rating-survey item scores it, where it sits on the severity map, and the phase that corrects it.

1. Vehicular Access

2 FINDINGS

1

1.1 Parking – Pedestrian crossing markings

MEDIUM

\$400–\$800

Markings are worn and do not clearly show the crossing. Repaint within 12 months. Est. \$400–\$800.

MEASURED	Worn, faded
STANDARD	B651 §8.3.4 requires crosswalks to be clearly marked.
SCORED UNDER	RHFAC 1.1.8 — Pedestrian crossings within parking areas · 3 points

On the plan: Site approach · Crossing · pin 1 **When:** Phase 1 · Year 1 · rank 5 of 14

2

1.1 Parking – Shelter over accessible spaces

ADVISORY

Not costed

No weather protection over the designated accessible spaces. A canopy is recommended as best practice; not included in the capital plan total.

MEASURED	None
STANDARD	<i>No clause of CSA/ASC B651:23 sets a measurable minimum for this item. Scored by RHFAC; recorded as advisory best practice.</i>
SCORED UNDER	RHFAC 1.1.11 — Shelter for designated accessible spaces · 2 points

On the plan: Site approach · Accessible parking · pin 2 **When:** Not scheduled — Advisory best practice; a canopy is not costed.

2. Exterior Approach and Entrance

5 FINDINGS

3

2.2 Exterior ramp – running slope

HIGH

\$14,000–\$22,000

Measured at three points: 8.6%, 8.8%, 8.9%. Ramp re-grading or rebuild required. Est. \$14,000–\$22,000.

MEASURED	8.8%
STANDARD	B651 §5.5.1 requires a ramp running slope between 1:12 (8.33%) and 1:20 (5%), with landings no more than 9,000 mm apart.
SCORED UNDER	RHFAC 2.2.1 — Slope · 5 points

On the plan: Site approach · Exterior ramp · pin 3 **When:** Phase 1 · Year 1 · rank 12 of 14

2. Exterior Approach and Entrance

CONTINUED

4

2.2 Exterior ramp – width

HIGH

Costed in finding 3

60 mm below the minimum. Corrected by the ramp rebuild in finding 3; costed there.

MEASURED 1,140 mm

STANDARD B651 §8.2.7 requires an exterior ramp to be at least 1,200 mm wide and to meet the running slope of §5.5.1.

SCORED UNDER **RHFAC 2.2.2** — Clear width · 3 points

On the plan: Site approach · Exterior ramp · pin 4 **When:** Phase 1 · Year 1 · rank 12 of 14

5

2.2 Tactile warning – top of ramp

HIGH

\$800–\$1,200

No detectable warning strip at top of ramp. Est. \$800–\$1,200.

MEASURED Absent

STANDARD B651 §4.4.5 requires tactile walking indicator surfaces to warn of hazards and guide direction at key decision points.

SCORED UNDER **RHFAC 2.2 §** — Scored within survey section 2.2 — Exterior Ramps

On the plan: Site approach · Exterior ramp · pin 5 **When:** Phase 1 · Year 1 · rank 12 of 14

6

2.4 Building entrance door – clear width

MEDIUM

Not costed

2 mm below the minimum, just outside the laser's $\pm 1/16$ in (about ± 1.6 mm) accuracy. Re-measure to confirm; if confirmed, offset hinges restore the clear width.

MEASURED 858 mm

STANDARD B651 §5.2.1 requires a doorway to have a clear opening width of at least 860 mm.

SCORED UNDER **RHFAC 2.4.9** — Clear opening width of entrance doors · 5 points

On the plan: Main floor · Lobby and entrance · pin 6 **When:** Not scheduled — Re-measure first; 0.4 mm outside the laser's tolerance.

7

2.4 Entrance door – operating force

HIGH

\$180–\$350

Exceeds max by 3 N. Door closer adjustment or replacement. Est. \$180–\$350.

MEASURED 41 N (pull)

STANDARD B651 §5.2.8 limits door-opening force to 38 N for exterior swinging doors and 22 N for interior swinging doors.

SCORED UNDER **RHFAC 2.4.3** — Power-operated door or easy-to-open door · 5 points

On the plan: Main floor · Lobby and entrance · pin 7 **When:** Phase 1 · Year 1 · rank 3 of 14

3. Interior Circulation

3 FINDINGS

8

3.3 Corridor — clear width at the narrowest point

Periodical shelving encroaches on the corridor. Repositioning the shelving resolves it at no cost; staff action.

MEASURED	1,130 mm
STANDARD	B651 §5.1.1 requires an accessible route to have a clear width of at least 1,200 mm.
SCORED UNDER	RHFAC 3.3.1 — Clear width · 5 points

On the plan: Main floor · Periodical stacks · pin 8 **When:** Phase 1 · Year 1 · rank 1 of 14

HIGHStaff action · \$0

9

3.5 Elevator — control panel height

130 mm above maximum. Panel replacement or supplementary low panel required. Est. \$3,500–\$6,500.

MEASURED	1,330 mm (highest button)
STANDARD	B651 §4.3.3 requires the centreline of operating controls to sit between 400 and 1,200 mm from the floor.
SCORED UNDER	RHFAC 3.5.10 — Controls inside elevator cab at accessible height and location · 4 points

On the plan: Main floor · Elevator · pin 9 **When:** Phase 1 · Year 1 · rank 9 of 14

HIGH\$3,500–\$6,500

10

3.5 Elevator — audio floor announcement

Audio floor announcements absent. Technician reprogramming. Est. \$200–\$400.

MEASURED	Absent
STANDARD	B651 §5.6.1 requires an accessible elevator to comply with Appendix E of ASME A17.1/CSA B44.
SCORED UNDER	RHFAC 3.5.13 — Audible elevator components · 4 points

On the plan: Main floor · Elevator · pin 10 **When:** Phase 1 · Year 1 · rank 4 of 14

MEDIUM\$200–\$400

4. Interior Services and Environment

4 FINDINGS

11

4.2 Service counter — height

No lowered section. Est. \$2,800–\$4,500 for lowered section addition.

MEASURED	960 mm full length
STANDARD	B651 §6.7.1.2 requires a table or counter surface to sit between 730 and 860 mm from the floor.
SCORED UNDER	RHFAC 4.2.1 — Desk/counters accessible height or variety of heights · 5 points

On the plan: Main floor · Service desk · pin 11 **When:** Phase 1 · Year 1 · rank 6 of 14

HIGH\$2,800–\$4,500

4. Interior Services and Environment

CONTINUED

12

4.2 Service counter – knee clearance

HIGH

Costed in finding 11

No knee clearance at any counter section. Corrected by the lowered counter section in finding 11; costed there.

MEASURED **None present**

STANDARD B651 §6.7.1.3 requires knee clearance of at least 820 mm wide by 480 mm deep by 685 mm high where a forward approach is used.

SCORED UNDER **RHFAC 4.2.2** — Space for knee clearance at transaction points for public and staff · 5 points

On the plan: Main floor · Service desk · pin 12 **When:** Phase 1 · Year 1 · rank 6 of 14

13

4.2 Self-service kiosk – reach height

HIGH

\$4,500–\$8,000

70 mm above maximum reach for seated users. Accessible terminal required. Est. \$4,500–\$8,000.

MEASURED **1,270 mm screen centre**

STANDARD B651 §4.3.3 requires the centreline of operating controls to sit between 400 and 1,200 mm from the floor.

SCORED UNDER **RHFAC 4.2.8** — Accessible interactive self-service transaction kiosks · 5 points

On the plan: Main floor · Self-checkout · pin 13 **When:** Phase 1 · Year 1 · rank 7 of 14

14

4.5 Acoustic – background noise

MEDIUM

Not costed

HVAC noise is audible in the quiet zones but was not measured with a sound level meter. An acoustic assessment is recommended before any work is priced; noise may also affect hearing-loop performance.

MEASURED **HVAC audible in quiet zones**

STANDARD B651 §4.7.3 addresses acoustics, including background noise that interferes with communication.

SCORED UNDER **RHFAC 4.5.1** — Sound damping and background noise · 5 points

On the plan: Upper floor · Quiet reading zone · pin 14 **When:** Not scheduled — Needs an acoustic assessment before it can be priced.

5. Sanitary Facilities

3 FINDINGS

15

5.1 Grab bar – rear wall height

CRITICAL

\$760–\$1,360

40 mm below the minimum. Both bars remain at their original 1997 construction height. Relocation required. Est. \$380–\$680 per bar, \$760–\$1,360 for both.

MEASURED 710 mm

STANDARD B651 §6.2.5 and Figure 45 require grab bars at least 600 mm long, mounted 750–850 mm above the floor, slip-resistant, 30–40 mm in diameter, and able to resist 1.3 kN.

SCORED UNDER RHFAC 5.1.9 — Grab bars at appropriate height and locations at toilets · 5 points (one survey item shared with finding 16; counted once)

On the plan: Main floor · Accessible washrooms · pin 15 When: Phase 0 · immediate

16

5.1 Grab bar – side wall height

CRITICAL

Costed in finding 15

35 mm below the minimum. Relocated together with the rear-wall bar; costed in finding 15.

MEASURED 715 mm

STANDARD B651 §6.2.5 and Figure 45 require grab bars at least 600 mm long, mounted 750–850 mm above the floor, slip-resistant, 30–40 mm in diameter, and able to resist 1.3 kN.

SCORED UNDER RHFAC 5.1.9 — Grab bars at appropriate height and locations at toilets · 5 points (one survey item shared with finding 15; counted once)

On the plan: Main floor · Accessible washrooms · pin 16 When: Phase 0 · immediate

17

5.3 Universal washroom

MEDIUM

\$18,000–\$32,000

No universal washroom. Required for Gold, not for base Certified status. Min. 2,100 × 2,100 mm clear area needed. Est. \$18,000–\$32,000.

MEASURED Absent

STANDARD B651 §6.3.1 requires a universal washroom with a single toilet and lavatory to provide a clear area of at least 2,100 by 2,100 mm.

SCORED UNDER RHFAC 5.3.1 — Number of universal washrooms · 5 points

On the plan: Main floor · Accessible washrooms · pin 17 When: Phase 2 · Year 2 · rank 14 of 14

6. Wayfinding and Signage

4 FINDINGS

18

6.1 Directional signage to accessible washroom

HIGH

\$180–\$320

No directional sign provided. Est. \$180–\$320.

MEASURED **Absent**

STANDARD B651 §4.6.1 governs the location of signage so that it is visible from the approach and at decision points.

SCORED UNDER **RHFAC 6.1.1** — Interior directional signage is comprehensive and clearly visible · 5 points

On the plan: Main floor · Lobby and entrance · pin 18 **When:** Phase 1 · Year 1 · rank 2 of 14

19

6.1 Tactile attention indicators — entry

HIGH

\$6,000–\$11,000

No tactile wayfinding indicators. Est. \$6,000–\$11,000 main floor.

MEASURED **Absent**

STANDARD B651 §4.4.5 requires tactile walking indicator surfaces to warn of hazards and guide direction at key decision points.

SCORED UNDER **RHFAC 6.1.3** — Wayfinding includes a variety of techniques · 5 points

On the plan: Main floor · Lobby and entrance · pin 19 **When:** Phase 1 · Year 1 · rank 11 of 14

20

6.2 Room ID signs — Braille

HIGH

\$3,800–\$6,500

Braille on meeting room only. Full facility replacement required. Est. \$3,800–\$6,500.

MEASURED **Partial — meeting room only**

STANDARD B651 §4.6.6 requires tactile signs to supplement the text of identification signs — rooms, titles, names and numbers — with raised characters and braille placed near the bottom edge.

SCORED UNDER **RHFAC 6.2.2** — Sign includes Braille and characters/symbols that are raised · 4 points (one survey item shared with finding 21; counted once)

On the plan: Both floors · no single room · no pin **When:** Phase 1 · Year 1 · rank 10 of 14

21

6.2 Room ID signs — tactile characters

HIGH

Costed in finding 20

Corrected by the sign replacement in finding 20; costed there.

MEASURED **Absent on non-compliant signs**

STANDARD B651 §4.6.6 requires tactile signs to supplement the text of identification signs — rooms, titles, names and numbers — with raised characters and braille placed near the bottom edge.

SCORED UNDER **RHFAC 6.2.2** — Sign includes Braille and characters/symbols that are raised · 4 points (one survey item shared with finding 20; counted once)

On the plan: Both floors · no single room · no pin **When:** Phase 1 · Year 1 · rank 10 of 14

7. Emergency Systems

3 FINDINGS

22

7.1 Area of rescue assistance – Level 2

CRITICAL

\$2,200–\$4,500

CRITICAL LIFE SAFETY. No designated area of refuge or two-way communication system on Level 2. Est. \$2,200–\$4,500 including signage and two-way communication device.

MEASURED **Absent**

STANDARD B651 §5.7.2 requires an area of refuge to form part of an accessible path of travel, with a compliant door and two-way communication.

SCORED UNDER **RHFAC 7.1.1** — Designated area of refuge in multi-level building · 5 points

On the plan: Upper floor · Stairwell · pin 22 **When:** Phase 0 · immediate

23

7.2 Visual fire alarms – Level 1

CRITICAL

\$8,500–\$14,000

CRITICAL LIFE SAFETY. No visual fire alarm devices on Level 1. Combined full facility estimate for Level 1 and Level 2: \$8,500–\$14,000. Immediate remediation required.

MEASURED **Absent throughout Level 1**

STANDARD B651 §5.7.1 requires visible alarms consisting of lights that flash in conjunction with the audible alarm, at a flash rate of 1 to 3 Hz.

SCORED UNDER **RHFAC 7.2.1** — Visual fire alarms generally visible throughout facility and where people might expect to be alone · 5 points (one survey item shared with finding 24; counted once)

On the plan: Main floor · whole floor · no pin **When:** Phase 0 · immediate

24

7.2 Visual fire alarms – Level 2

CRITICAL

Costed in finding 23

CRITICAL LIFE SAFETY. Same deficiency as Level 1. Included in the combined estimate under finding 23.

MEASURED **Absent throughout Level 2**

STANDARD B651 §5.7.1 requires visible alarms consisting of lights that flash in conjunction with the audible alarm, at a flash rate of 1 to 3 Hz.

SCORED UNDER **RHFAC 7.2.1** — Visual fire alarms generally visible throughout facility and where people might expect to be alone · 5 points (one survey item shared with finding 23; counted once)

On the plan: Upper floor · whole floor · no pin **When:** Phase 0 · immediate

8. Additional Use of Spaces

2 FINDINGS

25

8.21 Library – accessible stacks aisle width

HIGH

Staff action · \$0

Periodical stacks aisle below the minimum. Corrected by the same shelving reposition as finding 8; no cost.

MEASURED	1,130 mm
STANDARD	B651 §5.1.1 requires an accessible route to have a clear width of at least 1,200 mm.
SCORED UNDER	RHFAC 8.21.3 — Book stacks and shelving · 3 points

On the plan: Main floor · Periodical stacks · pin 25 When: Phase 1 · Year 1 · rank 1 of 14

26

8.21 Library – self-checkout reach height

HIGH

Costed in finding 13

The self-checkout terminal recorded in finding 13, scored again under the library-specific survey item. Corrected by the same accessible terminal; costed once, under finding 13.

MEASURED	1,270 mm screen centre
STANDARD	B651 §4.3.3 requires the centreline of operating controls to sit between 400 and 1,200 mm from the floor.
SCORED UNDER	RHFAC 8.21.7 — Accessible interactive self-service transaction kiosks · 5 points

On the plan: Main floor · Self-checkout · pin 26 When: Phase 1 · Year 1 · rank 7 of 14

11. Mind-Friendly Environments

1 FINDING

27

11.2 Sensory – adjustable lighting

ADVISORY

\$4,500–\$8,000

No dimmable zones. Fixed high-output fluorescent throughout. Upgrade to adjustable LED. Est. \$4,500–\$8,000.

MEASURED	Fixed fluorescent only
STANDARD	No clause of CSA/ASC B651:23 sets a measurable minimum for this item. Scored by RHFAC; recorded as advisory best practice.
SCORED UNDER	RHFAC 11.2.4 — Structural and task lighting is independently adjustable and customizable to user preferences. · 2 points

On the plan: Both floors · no single room · no pin When: Phase 2 · Year 2 · rank 13 of 14

12. Technology & Innovation

1 FINDING

28

12.2 Website – accessibility information

ADVISORY

\$800–\$2,000

The library website says nothing about the building’s accessibility — entrance, elevator, accessible washroom. Add an accessibility page, and while it is open fix the missing alt text on event images and the low-contrast events calendar. Est. \$800–\$2,000.

MEASURED	No page describing the building’s accessibility
STANDARD	No clause of CSA/ASC B651:23 sets a measurable minimum for this item. Scored by RHFAC; recorded as advisory best practice.
SCORED UNDER	RHFAC 12.2.1 — General information about accessibility of the site (e.g., elevators) · 2 points

On the plan: Not a physical location · no pin When: Phase 1 · Year 1 · rank 8 of 14

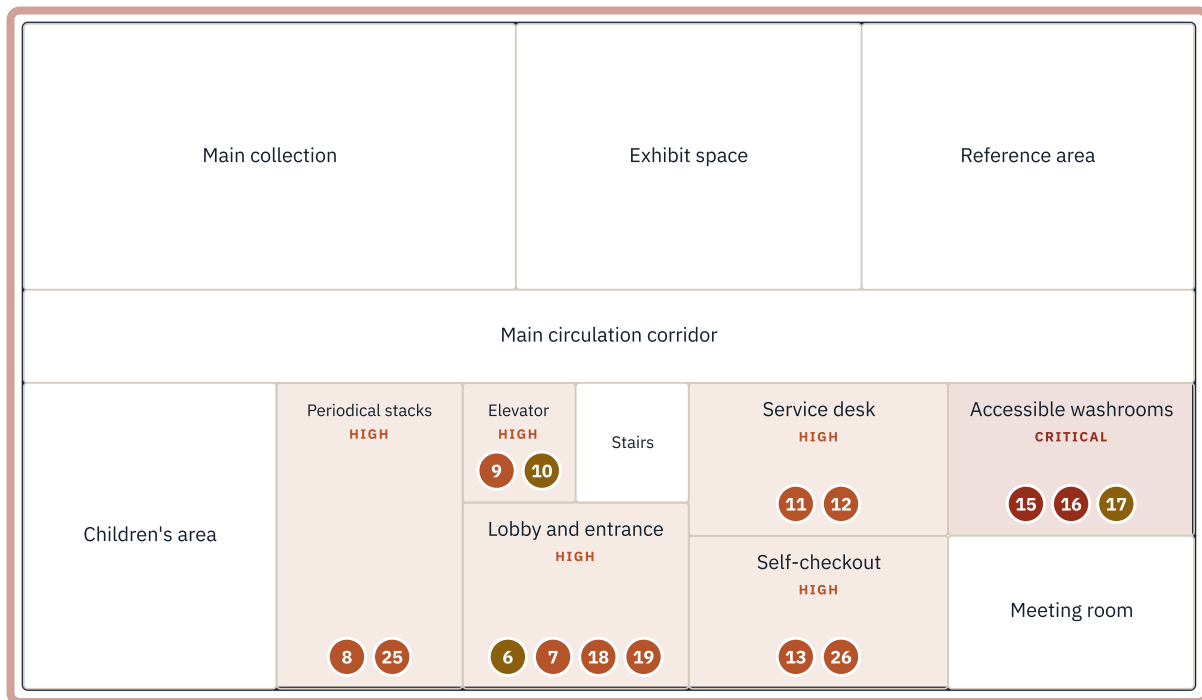
05 · SEVERITY MAP

Where the findings are.

Every finding that can be placed is pinned to the room it was recorded in, and each area is shaded by the most serious finding inside it. Pin numbers are the finding numbers in Section 04.

WHOLE FLOOR

Finding 23 — no visual fire alarm coverage on the main floor. A whole-floor failure, so it carries no single pin. Costed once, with the upper floor, at \$8,500–\$14,000.


SITE APPROACH

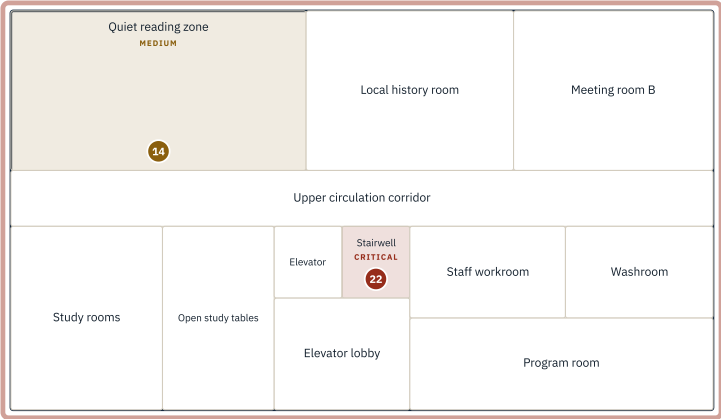

● Critical ● High ● Medium ● Advisory ○ No finding recorded

Pin numbers are the finding numbers in Section 04. Every area is also labelled in words, so the plan does not depend on colour. The dark red band around the floor marks a finding that applies to every room on it.

Main floor and site approach, Clearwater Public Library. Schematic — drawn to record where each finding was observed, not to scale, and not a construction drawing. The site approach is drawn dashed to mark it as exterior. The elevator serves both floors; its findings are pinned on this floor only, so they are counted once.

Upper floor.

WHOLE FLOOR Finding 24 — no visual fire alarm coverage on the upper floor. Included in the combined \$8,500–\$14,000 estimate under finding 23.



● Critical ● High ● Medium ● Advisory ○ No finding recorded

Pin numbers are the finding numbers in Section 04. Every area is also labelled in words, so the plan does not depend on colour. The dark red band around the floor marks a finding that applies to every room on it.

Upper floor, Clearwater Public Library. Schematic — not to scale. The elevator appears on both plans; its findings are pinned on the main floor only.

How an area gets its colour

LEVEL	RULE	FINDINGS
CRITICAL	A life-safety finding. Corrected first, regardless of cost.	15, 16, 22, 23, 24
HIGH	A measured value fails a clause of B651:23.	3, 4, 5, 7, 8, 9, 11, 12, 13, 18, 19, 20, 21, 25, 26
MEDIUM	Close to the limit, or a Gold prerequisite rather than an outright failure.	1, 6, 10, 14, 17
ADVISORY	No measurable minimum in B651:23. Still scored by RHFAC; treated as best practice.	2, 27, 28

Who uses these plans

Council See where the money goes, and why the washrooms and stairwell come first.	Contractors Know which rooms to visit before pricing, for faster, closer quotes.	Grant applications Plans, severity and zone costs support the needs case a funder asks for.
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Optional measured plans. For larger buildings, tenders or grants, Novo can supply plans drawn from site measurements (drawn in magicplan), with the same shading, pins and zone costs.

05 · SEVERITY MAP, CONTINUED

Zone index.

Each area on the plans, its worst finding, the phase that corrects it, and the cost.

AREA	FLOOR	WORST	FINDINGS	PHASE	ESTIMATE
Accessible parking	Site	ADVISORY	2	Not scheduled	Not costed
Crossing	Site	MEDIUM	1	P1	\$400–\$800
Exterior ramp	Site	HIGH	3, 4, 5	P1	\$14,800–\$23,200
Periodical stacks	Main	HIGH	8, 25	P1	\$0 · staff action
Elevator	Main	HIGH	9, 10	P1	\$3,700–\$6,900
Lobby and entrance	Main	HIGH	6, 7, 18, 19	P1, Not scheduled	\$6,360–\$11,670
Service desk	Main	HIGH	11, 12	P1	\$2,800–\$4,500
Self-checkout	Main	HIGH	13, 26	P1	\$4,500–\$8,000
Accessible washrooms	Main	CRITICAL	15, 16, 17	P0, P2	\$18,760–\$33,360
Quiet reading zone	Upper	MEDIUM	14	Not scheduled	Not costed
Stairwell	Upper	CRITICAL	22	P0	\$2,200–\$4,500
Whole floor and non-spatial	Both	CRITICAL	20, 21, 23, 24, 27, 28	P0, P1, P2	\$17,600–\$30,500
All 28 findings			1–28		\$71,120–\$123,430

This table reconciles to the capital plan

The zone total of **\$71,120–\$123,430** equals the three-phase total in Section 07. Each estimate appears once, against the area where the work is done.

FINDINGS THAT BELONG TO NO SINGLE ROOM

Six findings carry no pin.

#	FINDING	EXTENT	SEVERITY	PHASE
20	Room identification signs lack braille	Both levels	HIGH	P1
21	Room identification signs lack raised characters	Both levels	HIGH	P1
23	No visual fire alarm coverage anywhere on the floor	Level 1	CRITICAL	P0
24	No visual fire alarm coverage anywhere on the floor	Level 2	CRITICAL	P0
27	Fixed fluorescent lighting, no adjustable zones	Both levels	ADVISORY	P2
28	Website gives no accessibility information	Not location-specific	ADVISORY	P1

06 · WHERE THE NEXT DOLLAR GOES

Ranked by points gained *per dollar*.

Life safety comes first. Every other action is ranked by points recovered per \$1,000 at the midpoint of its cost range, so a cheap fix that closes a real gap outranks a costly one that closes a small gap.

RANK	ACTION	FINDINGS	PTS	ESTIMATE	PTS / \$1K	RUNNING
0	Life safety — Phase 0 Alarms, area of rescue, grab bars. Placed ahead of the ranking.	15, 16, 22-24	+15	\$11,460–\$19,860	—	724
1	Move periodical shelving (1,200 mm aisle)	8, 25	+8	\$0	no cost	732
2	Directional sign to accessible washroom	18	+5	\$180–\$320	20.0	737
3	Adjust entrance door closer to 38 N	7	+5	\$180–\$350	18.9	742
4	Reprogram elevator audio announcements	10	+4	\$200–\$400	13.3	746
5	Repaint parking crossing markings	1	+3	\$400–\$800	5.0	749
6	Lowered service counter section	11, 12	+10	\$2,800–\$4,500	2.7	759 CERTIFIED
7	Accessible self-checkout terminal	13, 26	+10	\$4,500–\$8,000	1.6	769
8	Add a website accessibility page	28	+2	\$800–\$2,000	1.4	771
9	Low elevator control panel	9	+4	\$3,500–\$6,500	0.8	775
10	Braille and raised-letter room signs	20, 21	+4	\$3,800–\$6,500	0.8	779
11	Tactile attention indicators at entry	19	+5	\$6,000–\$11,000	0.6	784
12	Rebuild exterior ramp, tactile strip	3, 4, 5	+8	\$14,800–\$23,200	0.4	792
13	Adjustable LED lighting	27	+2	\$4,500–\$8,000	0.3	794
14	Universal washroom	17	+5	\$18,000–\$32,000	0.2	799
All actions		25 findings	+90	\$71,120–\$123,430		799

Reading this table

The running total starts at 709 (today's score) plus 15 from Phase 0, and crosses the 756-point Certified threshold at rank 6; ranks 1–6 cost **\$3,760–\$6,370**. A corrected item is assumed to earn its full survey value, and a survey item shared by two findings is counted once. The ramp's tactile strip has no numbered item, so it adds cost but no points. Not in the plan: finding 2 — Advisory best practice; a canopy is not costed. finding 6 — Re-measure first; 0.4 mm outside the laser's tolerance. finding 14 — Needs an acoustic assessment before it can be priced.

07 · CAPITAL PLAN

Three phases, mapped to *budget cycles*.

Phase 0 does not wait for a budget cycle. Phase 1 meets both the points threshold and the entrance prerequisite for Certified. Phase 2 adds the universal washroom that Gold requires.

Phase 0 IMMEDIATE

\$11,460–\$19,860

Life safety. Corrected first, whatever the score or certification goal. **Work:** visual fire alarms, both floors (23, 24); area of rescue, upper floor (22); relocate washroom grab bars (15, 16).

On the plan: Both floors (alarms); accessible washrooms; upper stairwell.

+15 points 724 / 1,259 = 58%

Phase 1 YEAR 1 (2026–27)

\$37,160–\$63,570

Ranks 1–6 pass the points threshold; ranks 7–12 follow, including the ramp, which the entrance prerequisite requires. **Work:** move periodical shelving (1,200 mm aisle) (8, 25); directional sign to accessible washroom (18); adjust entrance door closer to 38 N (7); reprogram elevator audio announcements (10); repaint parking crossing markings (1); lowered service counter section (11, 12); accessible self-checkout terminal (13, 26); add a website accessibility page (28); low elevator control panel (9); braille and raised-letter room signs (20, 21); tactile attention indicators at entry (19); rebuild exterior ramp, tactile strip (3, 4, 5).

On the plan: Site approach and ramp, lobby, periodical stacks, elevator, service desk, self-checkout; signs on both floors.

+68 points 792 / 1,259 = 63%

CERTIFIED

Phase 2 YEAR 2 (2027–28)

\$22,500–\$40,000

The two lowest-ranked actions. **Work:** adjustable LED lighting (27); universal washroom (17).

On the plan: Both floors (lighting); accessible washrooms.

+7 points 799 / 1,259 = 63%

FULL PLAN, THREE PHASES

\$71,120–\$123,430 before grants

Why the ramp is in Year 1

It ranks 12th on points per dollar, but RHF certification requires an accessible public entrance. Points alone would not certify the library without it. It is also a strong grant candidate.

Gold is a separate decision

With every planned finding corrected the score is 799 (63%); Gold needs 1,008. Findings 2, 6, 14 could add up to 12 more. The other 197 points come from features RHFAC rewards beyond the minimum. Novo can scope a Gold plan separately.

08 · PORTFOLIO ROLL-UP

The same barrier at four buildings is *one contract*.

Five Town facilities were assessed to the same standard. A barrier found at more than one is reported once, as a systemic finding, and costed across the portfolio.

FACILITY	BUILT	LEVELS	EARNED	APPLICABLE	SCORE	CERTIFIED AT	GAP
Clearwater Public Library	1997	2	709	1,259	56%	756	47 pts short
Clearwater Civic Centre	1992	3	690	1,301	53%	781	91 pts short
Clearwater Recreation Centre	2004	2	845	1,342	63%	806	Threshold met
Clearwater Seniors' Centre	1988	1	559	1,166	48%	700	141 pts short
Clearwater Public Works	2011	1	761	1,118	68%	671	Threshold met
Portfolio total	—	9	3,564	6,186	58%	3,714	3 of 5 below threshold

Eight barriers recur at two or more facilities

One procurement, one mobilisation and one inspection cycle cost less than four. "Fixed separately" applies this library's estimate to each site. ♦ marks life safety.

SYSTEMIC FINDING	FACILITIES	FIXED SEPARATELY	AS ONE CONTRACT	SAVING	%
No visual fire alarms ♦	3 of 5	\$25,500–\$42,000	\$21,700–\$35,700	\$3,800–\$6,300	15%
Grab bars below 750 mm ♦	4 of 5	\$3,040–\$5,440	\$2,280–\$4,080	\$760–\$1,360	25%
No upper-floor area of rescue ♦	2 of 5	\$4,400–\$9,000	\$3,740–\$7,650	\$660–\$1,350	15%
No tactile indicators at entry	5 of 5	\$30,000–\$55,000	\$24,000–\$44,000	\$6,000–\$11,000	20%
Room signs lack braille	4 of 5	\$15,200–\$26,000	\$10,640–\$18,200	\$4,560–\$7,800	30%
No lowered counter section	3 of 5	\$8,400–\$13,500	\$6,720–\$10,800	\$1,680–\$2,700	20%
Entrance door force above 38 N	4 of 5	\$720–\$1,400	\$480–\$930	\$240–\$470	33%
No washroom directional sign	3 of 5	\$540–\$960	\$380–\$670	\$160–\$290	30%
Total — 8 systemic findings	28	\$87,800–\$153,300	\$69,940–\$122,030	\$17,860–\$31,270	20%

Root cause

Grab bars sit at 705–720 mm in all four facilities built before 2005. No facility, even the 2011 one, has tactile indicators at entry. No accessibility specification appears to be attached to the Town's capital projects.

Recommendation: adopt a written accessibility specification, referencing CSA/ASC B651:23, for all Town capital projects and major renovations. It stops the next building from joining this list, at no capital cost.

09 · FUNDING PROGRAMS

Two programs match *work in this report.*

FEDERAL

Enabling Accessibility Fund

Up to \$125,000

Small projects component, Employment and Social Development Canada. Municipalities are eligible. Funds construction and renovation that improves accessibility — the ramp rebuild, universal washroom, tactile indicators and signage in Phases 1 and 2 all fall inside its scope.

Status, September 2026: no small projects intake is open; the last one ran May to July 2024. A separate 2026 call for larger projects (\$500,000 to \$1,000,000) closed March 16, 2026. Confirm before citing a figure in a council report.

NATIONAL

RBC Barrier Buster Grants

Up to \$40,000

Rick Hansen Foundation with RBC and RBC Foundation. Recipients have included municipalities. Suits the low-cost and mid-cost items — signage, door hardware, lighting and wayfinding.

Status, September 2026: applications are closed; 40 recipients were announced during National AccessAbility Week (May 31 to June 6, 2026). Confirm whether a further round is planned.

10 · WHAT THE ESTIMATES ARE BASED ON

Order-of-magnitude, not quotations.

Cost ranges reflect supply and install at prevailing Alberta municipal rates, excluding GST, permit fees, asbestos or hazardous-material abatement, and any structural work uncovered once finishes are opened. Ranges widen where site conditions cannot be confirmed without invasive investigation. A range is given rather than a single figure because a report that hands council one number invites a variance conversation later. For tender, obtain three quotations against the scope described in each finding; the zone index in Section 05 tells each bidder which rooms to visit.

Measurement

Measurements were taken with calibrated equipment: a Bosch GLM165-27CGL laser measure (accurate to $\pm 1/16$ in, about ± 1.6 mm), its built-in 360° inclinometer for slopes, a force gauge for door-opening force, and a lux meter for illumination. Slopes were measured at three points and the least favourable recorded. A value within the laser's tolerance of a limit is re-measured before work is priced.

Floor plans

The plans in Section 05 are schematic: they record where each finding was observed and are not to scale. Plans drawn in magicplan from site measurements are available as an option for larger buildings, tenders and grant applications.

11 · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

Four steps, and the first two *cost nothing*.

- 1 **Circulate this report.** The one-page summary is written to be shared on its own. Administration, finance and the accessibility advisory committee each need a different part of it; the contents page says which.
- 2 **Authorise Phase 0.** The three life-safety problems (\$11,460–\$19,860) do not wait for a capital cycle and can usually be approved within simplified purchasing thresholds.
- 3 **Complete the six gap-closing actions.** \$3,760–\$6,370, alongside Phase 0, passes the 756-point Certified threshold and gives council visible progress while the larger plan moves through approval. Schedule the ramp rebuild in the same year: certification also needs an accessible public entrance.
- 4 **Decide on submission.** If the Town intends to pursue formal RHF certification, the prerequisites in Section 01 must be cleared first and the rating submitted to the RHFAC Registry by a designated professional.

12 · CREDENTIALS AND METHODOLOGY

Who prepared this

Carl Christie, RHFAC Professional. The designation is earned through the Rick Hansen Foundation's RHFAC Professional course and the exam administered by CSA Group, and is maintained through Accessibility Professional Network membership. Novo Industries Inc. BN 716914023. CanadaBuys / SAP Ariba ANID AN11298778565.

Method

Every applicable item of the RHFAC v4.0 Rating Survey was inspected on site and scored. Each barrier was then cross-referenced to the clause of CSA/ASC B651:23 that sets its measurable requirement; findings with no corresponding clause are recorded as advisory. Each finding was pinned to a schematic floor plan and shaded by severity. Costs were assigned per finding and counted once, and the sequence was set by dividing points recoverable by midpoint cost, with life-safety items placed ahead of the ranking.

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This is a Novo Accessibility Assessment using RHFAC methodology. It does not confer RHF certification. Sample report — facility, scores and findings shown are not actual assessment data.